LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 54 · November 11, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

One kind may never stand in for another: teruma and tithes must be separated from each kind for itself — wine for wine, grain for grain — derived by kal va-chomer from kilayim, and carried into animal tithe, where herd and flock are counted separately but sheep and goats count as one flock. The mishnah then asks how far apart animals may be and still join as one flock: sixteen mil, the distance a grazing animal walks under one shepherd's eye.

KILAYIM · ONE MIN, TWO COLORS



1. Purple grapes and green grapes are obviously one min — so one shehecheyanu should cover both. But what if you haven't eaten grapes all year, and you make shehecheyanu — do you make a separate one for the purple and one for the green?

“Some poskim say yes — because shehecheyanu depends on simcha, and every type of grape brings with it its own simcha. A new color, a new joy, a new blessing.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 54a · the kal va-chomer — wheat for barley · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Elefant · 7:59

KILAYIM · THE ONE-HANDFUL RULE



2. Rav Oshaya says kilayim of the vineyard only applies if you sow wheat, barley and a grape seed in a single handful — במפולת יד. So what is the nafka mina: does it matter whether the seeds are in one hand or in two?

“If the Torah cares about the hand, two hands are fine. If it cares about the seeds growing side by side, two hands still put them side by side. Same hands, same seeds — two completely different halachot, depending on why you think the Torah said 'one handful.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 54a · Rav Oshaya's one-handful sowing · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Elefant · 13:42

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MAASER BEHEMAH · THE SHEPHERD'S EYE



3. The mishnah says flocks combine for maaser behemah within sixteen mil — as far as a shepherd's eye can see. Sixteen mil is a very far distance, and most people can't see sixteen mil. Meanwhile, if a husband falls into waters with no end, more than a mil away we can't assume you saw what happened.

“It depends what kind of attention you're giving: to tell whether your husband drowned you need to see clearly, but a shepherd only has to give his flock 'basic supervision.' And by the same logic, a sukkah over twenty amot is pasul — but a shepherd can see sixteen mil. Close attention is short; loose attention is sixteen mil.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 54b · sixteen mil under one shepherd's eye · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Elefant · 37:40

MAASER BEHEMAH · HOW FAR IS ONE FLOCK?



4. The poskim ask: if you daven minyan outside in an open field, how far apart can the ten men stand and still count as one minyan? Minchat Yitzchak and Rav Shlomo Zalman say they must all be able to hear the baal tefillah.

“But our gemara says a shepherd's flock counts as one over sixteen mil — so maybe, if your chazzan has a strong enough voice, your minyan could stretch for miles. One minyan, sixteen mil wide, as long as everyone can hear 'amen.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 54b · the shepherd's sixteen mil · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Elefant · 42:46

MAASER BEHEMAH · WHO SAID IT?



5. Rava first says the hekesh between animal tithe and grain tithe covers only the year rule — then the gemara uses the same hekesh for the kinds rule too. A straight contradiction in Rava.

“Two answers: either Rava retracted — or, as Tosafot explains, one of the statements wasn't Rava's at all, it was Rav Pappa's. Since Rav Pappa took over as rosh yeshiva after Rava, 'they very commonly got confused' between them. The academy mixed up its own rosh yeshiva.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 54b · Rava retracted — or was it Rav Pappa? · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Elefant · 34:06